

CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY → EPISTEMIC GATE → INFERENCE CONTROVERSY → MATERIAL ONTOLOGY → TRANSCENDENT DENIALS → ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE LOST BRĤASPATI-SŪTRA OPPONENT REPORTS QUOTED FRAGMENTS MĀDHAVA, JAYANTA, (OFTEN POLEMICAL) DISTINGUISH ATTESTED THESIS FROM HOSTILE CARICATURE THIS-WORLDLY ORIENTATION; CĀRVĀKA MATERIALIST SCHOOL LABEL

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Bṛhaspati-sūtra opponent reports quoted fragments (Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemical))	- RULE: distinguish attested thesis from hostile caricature - Lokāyata = this-worldly orientation; Cārvāka = materialist school label.	- CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Bṛhaspati-sūtra opponent reports quoted fragments (Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemical))

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: distinguish attested thesis from hostile caricature

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāna (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

01

STAGE 01 EPISTEMIC GATE

EPISTEMIC GATE VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES PERCEPTION ANUMĀNA ŚABDA UPAMĀNA DIRECT, SENSE-GROUNDED INFERENCE TESTIMONY COMPARISON SMOKE IS INVARIABLY FIRE-LINKED.

VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES

PRATYAKṢA / PERCEPTION anumāna śabda upamāna direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite	universal vyāpti outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked.	
SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES - PRATYAKṢA / PERCEPTION anumāna śabda upamāna direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite	- universal vyāpti outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked. - VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES	- PRATYAKṢA / PERCEPTION anumāna śabda upamāna direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite - universal vyāpti outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāna (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

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02

STAGE 02 INFERENCE CONTROVERSY

INFERENCE CONTROVERSY CĀRVĀKA ATTACK INFERENCE NEEDS UNIVERSAL CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) VYĀPTI KNOWN BY INFERENCE BY PERCEPTION INCOMPLETE SURVEY HIDDEN CONDITION (UPĀDHI) MAY DEFEAT THE RULE FIRE WITHOUT SMOKE, WET FUEL MATTERS NYĀYA REPLY

REPEATED AGREEMENT + ABSENCE OF COUNTER-INSTANCE + TARKA ANVAYA

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
- CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference → circularity - by perception → incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhi) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters	- NYĀYA REPLY: repeated agreement + absence of counter-instance + tarka anvaya (presence) + vyatireka (absence) → defeasible but rational vyāpti - CĀRVĀKA COUNTER-PRESSURE: practical expectation may work without certainty	- SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE: arguing against inference already employs inference. - CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference → circularity

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference → circularity | by perception → incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhi) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference → circularity | by perception → incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhi) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters.

03

STAGE 03 MATERIAL ONTOLOGY

MATERIAL ONTOLOGY ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED EARTH + WATER + ORGANISED LIVING BODY CONSCIOUSNESS CONSCIOUSNESS IS A BODY-PROPERTY, NOT AN IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCE FERMENTATION INGREDIENTS INTOXICATING POWER NOT PRESENT SEPARATELY

	ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living	
consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not	SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving ātman, rebirth	QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.
SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness - consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately	- SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving ātman, rebirth or afterlife - QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.	- ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness - consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

04

STAGE 04 TRANSCENDENT DENIALS

TRANSCENDENT DENIALS NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT NO IMMORTAL SOUL NO REBIRTH NO KARMA AS SUPERSENSIBLE MORAL FORCE NO HEAVEN/HELL NO POST-MORTEM REWARD OR PUNISHMENT NO CREATOR GOD

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT → no immortal soul → no rebirth → no karma as supersensible moral force → no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment → no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT - no immortal soul → no rebirth - no karma as supersensible moral force	- no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment - no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner - no Vedic infallibility → priestly testimony lacks intrinsic authority	RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

05

STAGE 05 ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER DHARMA REJECTED WHEN GROUNDED IN UNSEEN REWARD OR VEDIC COMMAND REJECTED AS LIBERATION OF A SEPARABLE SOUL ARTHA + INTELLIGIBLE GOODS WITHIN ONE EMBODIED LIFE PRUDENT ENJOYMENT RECKLESS INDULGENCE PLEASURE SOUGHT

WEIGH PAIN, SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE AND ATTAINABLE MEANS EXAM CONTROL

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command mokṣa: rejected as liberation of a separable soul artha + kāma: intelligible goods within one embodied life prudent enjoyment != reckless indulgence pleasure sought	— weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness	do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan "eat, drink and borrow." PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command mokṣa: rejected as liberation of a
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
- PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command mokṣa: rejected as liberation of a - separable soul artha + kāma: intelligible goods within one embodied life prudent enjoyment != reckless indulgence pleasure sought	— weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means - EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness	- do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan "eat, drink and borrow." - PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command mokṣa: rejected as liberation of a

MECHANISM / VERDICT — PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER dharma: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command mokṣa: rejected as liberation of a separable soul artha + kāma: intelligible goods within one embodied life prudent enjoyment != reckless indulgence pleasure sought → weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

06

STAGE 06 COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAP

COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAP ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM PRAMĀNA PERCEPTION ONLY FOUR PRAMĀNAS ANTI-DOGMATIC EVIDENTIAL DISCIPLINE PERCEPTION-ONLY RULE STRUGGLES TO JUSTIFY SCIENCE, MEMORY AND ITS

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM pramāna perception only four pramānas perception + inference self conscious body enduring ātman anātman stream causation observed sequence realist relation dependent origination transcendent denied God, soul, karma karma without creator liberation death	ends person apavarga nirvāna STRENGTH: anti-dogmatic evidential discipline	LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique. ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM pramāna perception only four pramānas perception + inference self conscious body enduring ātman anātman
DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
- ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM pramāna perception only four pramānas perception + inference self conscious body enduring ātman anātman - stream causation observed sequence realist relation dependent origination transcendent denied God, soul, karma karma without creator liberation death	- ends person apavarga nirvāna - STRENGTH: anti-dogmatic evidential discipline	- LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique. - ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM pramāna perception only four pramānas perception + inference self conscious body enduring ātman anātman

MECHANISM / VERDICT — LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER RAIL

PYQ ANSWER RAIL DEFINE SOURCE PROBLEM STATE PERCEPTION THESIS RECONSTRUCT INFERENCE ATTACK EXPLAIN UPĀDHI/CIRCULARITY GIVE NYĀYA REPLY ASSESS SELF-REFUTATION DERIVE MATERIALISM EMBODIED SELF TRANSCENDENT DENIALS

DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain upādhi/circularity → give assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result → QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower → needed to defend that challenge.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain upādhi/circularity → give Nyāya reply → - assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result	- QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower than the reasoning - needed to defend that challenge.	- DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain upādhi/circularity → give Nyāya reply → - assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT 1. HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM 2. EPISTEMOLOGY — PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀNA 3. THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE — VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI 4. THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE — AND A 5. METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM — FOUR BHŪTAS , THE 6. SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS — DEHĀTMAVĀDA , AND 7. THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES — GOD, SOUL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem 2. Epistemology — Perception as the Sole Pramāna 3. The Critique of Inference — Vyāpti , Upādhi , the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation 4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference — and a Critically Balanced Verdict	5. Metaphysics and Materialism — Four Bhūtas , the Rejection of Ākāśa , and Svabhāva-vāda 6. Self, Body and Consciousness — Dehātma-vāda , and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks) 7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities — God, Soul, Karma , Rebirth, Heaven, Mokṣa , Veda and Ritual 8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning — and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks)	9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture - A genuine early principle of epistemic economy; do not multiply unseen entities without warrant. - A real and still powerful problem about the warrant for universals and vyāpti. - A valuable naturalistic check on speculative metaphysics, ritualism, and unverifiable claims.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.